

Contact

p_vishakha@hotmail.com

www.linkedin.com/in/vishakharallabhandi (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Image Processing

Azure DevOps Server

Azure Service Fabric

Certifications

Career Essentials in Generative AI
by Microsoft and LinkedIn

AI Engineer Agentic Track: The
Complete Agent & MCP Course

Vishakha Rallabhandi

Engineering Leader | Project Management | Content Ingestion
& Personalization Platforms | GenAI and LLM Integration |
Cloud-Native Microservices & Platform Modernization

Redmond, Washington, United States

Summary

Engineering leader with more than a decade of experience architecting and delivering large-scale distributed systems, secure cloud-native platforms, and AI-integrated solutions across mission-critical content ecosystems. Recognized for leading cross-functional, globally distributed teams to build scalable, high-performance systems across Azure Cloud and microservices ecosystems.

Currently heading a high-performing engineering team driving modernization of content programming tools and image processing infrastructure across the MSN content ecosystem. I drive strategic initiatives that strengthen infrastructure security, modernize editorial workflows, and elevate platform resilience through scalable system design.

My leadership has played a key role in elevating content quality for Microsoft News—a personalized feed reaching over 700M monthly users globally—by minimizing visual defects, improving content quality, and streamlining operations across mission-critical content systems.

Experience

Microsoft

19 years

Principal Software Engineering Manager

August 2023 - Present (2 years 10 months)

Redmond, WA

Microsoft AI, Content Ecosystem & Growth

Led a team that successfully maintained and enhanced security of Content programming tools infrastructure, critical in programming some of editorial driven features like Breaking News for MSN and Bing image of the day.

- Directed product vision and roadmap for MSN's editorial and content-quality systems, partnering with product, editorial, compliance, and engineering teams to modernize workflows and scale global operations.
- Translated ambiguous editorial workflow challenges into clear product requirements, reducing content scheduling latency by 70% and enabling 100+ editors to publish real-time updates during global events.
- Drove design discussions for infrastructure changes to reduce technical debt, improve platform security and stability of the Tools and microservices.
- Led zero downtime migration of 10 microservices and web application to Azure PME cluster. Eliminated credential related risks through managed identity integration which resulted in higher service reliability and reduced operational overhead.

Led team responsible for Content quality and Image processing for MSN.com, Edge and Apps. Cross team collaboration with Bing, UX and News Feed teams to unify the serving stack and improve image quality and focal point detection.

Senior Software Engineering Lead

May 2022 - July 2023 (1 year 3 months)

Content publishing, Content quality and Intelligence

Led team responsible for improving content quality for all MSN platforms, and reducing visual defect rate by over 50% through LLM based defect detection.

- Partnered with product, business, legal (CELA), and applied science teams to translate requirements into maintainable roadmaps that drive alignment with long term platform strategy and measurable outcomes.
- Integrated LLMs into ingestion workflow and move from reactive troubleshooting toward proactive detection and automated remediation of content quality issues.
- Led design discussion to build a scalable solution for defect detection of 500K+ daily ingested content from over 5k brands, reducing the content defect rate from 13% to under 6%.
- Implemented cutting-edge technologies to improve content quality and user experience.
- Drove design and building of measurement pipeline, working with vendor company to get accurate measurement data.

Senior Software Engineer - Tech Lead

October 2017 - April 2022 (4 years 7 months)

Microsoft News and Feed, Content Services

Tech lead for Ingestion visual defect area. Created content quality guidelines, ramped up new members, designed the measurement plan, and led all dev efforts to proactively detect the defected content and demote them on ranking layer.

Unified User Profiles store for all of WebXT and achieved cost savings of \$5M/year.

As a Senior Software Engineer and Tech Lead, I spearheaded the development of User Profile Store which serves explicit personalization data for various platforms including MSN Apps, Msn.com, Bing.com, Edge browser, and Bing Maps. Designed the architecture of API and storage to provide scalable solution to serve user data across all canvases providing consistent user experience.

Mentored junior engineers, helping team members onboard and ramp up, cross-team collaboration to unify user experience.

Led the seamless migration of 4TB of personalization data to Azure Cosmos DB and Bing Object Store with zero data loss, improving reliability and long-term maintainability.

Worked with Junior developer to consolidate Cosmos DB partition, and successful in cost saving of 45k/month.

Owned real time and non-real time ingestion services for Finance structured data.

Senior Software Engineer

August 2010 - September 2017 (7 years 2 months)

MSN Core Platform, Windows Universal Store

Lead design and implementation of a generic Storage service for Content Management System that supports Msn.com, Msn Apps.

Designed and implemented Maintenance service to schedule and execute cleanup jobs in a controlled manner and enabling it to support additional features like data consistency check and dynamic scaling of storage account.

Executed seamless migration of video metadata platform from SQL Server 2008 R2 using classic mirroring to SQL Server 2012 with AlwaysOn architecture, ensuring zero downtime and uninterrupted service delivery.

Software Engineer

June 2007 - July 2010 (3 years 2 months)

MSN Entertainment, Video & Sport

Owned design and implementation of content management tools for MSN Entertainment, driving user engagement and traffic growth. Worked on various feature releases for MSN entertainment, ingesting "Metacritic" music reviews in Entertainment, development of the MSN Music online store.

Led successful migration of MSN Entertainment ratings and reviews to scalable and extendable MSN R&R platform, ensuring zero data loss and seamless integration across front-end and middle-tier systems.

Spearheaded backend modernization by upgrading legacy system's .NET framework and supporting SQL Server 2005 migration, contributing to improved performance and maintainability.

Designed and implemented a scalable and extensible news ingestion framework for MSN entertainment., streamlining onboarding of new Entertainment content providers, migrating legacy jobs and eliminating the need for custom job creation per provider.

Education

Mumbai University

Bachelor of Engineering - BE, Computer Science